

EDUCATION
INDIA'S **BEST** UNIVERSITIES

Citadels of LEARNING

The first INDIA TODAY-Nielsen Survey on the country's leading higher educational institutions identifies centres of excellence at a time when university education is at the centre of national controversy and in need of radical legislative reforms

By Sharda Ugra

Three years ago in June 2007, at a function to mark 150 years of the University of Mumbai, Prime Minister Manmohan Singh talked about the dream Indian universities. "These universities should be rated among the top institutions in the world... they must become the launchpad for entry into the knowledge economy."

Just as it has done in the last decade, it is this 'knowledge economy' which is expected to be the engine to further drive India's growth ahead at greater speed. The country put itself at the centre of the world's attention because of its qualified, English-speaking graduates, products of a rigorous, demanding and competitive university system. Once more, it is India's universities which will have to

